

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250282362

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 11, 2025

Inventor(s)

Ge; Yifeng et al.

SYSTEMS AND METHODS FOR DETERMINING AN ESTIMATED WEIGHT OF A VEHICLE

Abstract

Disclosed herein are methods for determining an estimated weight of a vehicle. The methods comprise operating at least one processor to: receive vehicle data associated with the vehicle, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of vehicle parameters collected during operation of the vehicle; identify one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data, each vehicle maneuver being associated with a portion of the vehicle data; and use at least one machine learning model to determine the estimated weight of the vehicle based on the portion of the vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the at least one machine learning model trained using training data associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers. Also disclosed are systems for implementing methods of the present disclosure.

Inventors: Ge; Yifeng (North York, CA), Sabahi; Mohammad Salman (North York, CA), Manjunath; Vinay Kiran (Kitchener, CA), Petersen; Willem (Elmira, CA)

Applicant: Geotab Inc. (Oakville, CA)

Family ID: 1000008332315

Appl. No.: 18/989153

Filed: December 20, 2024

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 18597400 20240306 parent-grant-document US 12208811 child US 18989153

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: B60W40/13 (20120101); G07C5/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **B60W40/13** (20130101); **G07C5/008** (20130101); B60W2556/10 (20200201);
B60W2556/45 (20200201)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application claims priority to and the benefit of U.S. Patent Application Ser. No. 63/413,035, filed on Oct. 4, 2022, U.S. Patent Application Ser. No. 63/430,514, filed on Dec. 6, 2022, and U.S. Patent Application Ser. No. 63/445,753, filed on Feb. 15, 2023, each of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety. This application is also a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/597,400, which, in turn, is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/111,951, each of which is also incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure generally relates to weight estimation. More specifically, the present disclosure relates to determining an estimated weight of a vehicle.

BACKGROUND

[0003] The weight of a vehicle may affect a number of aspects of its operation. For example, the weight of a commercial vehicle may affect whether the vehicle is subject to regulatory restrictions. In more detail, there are often regulations defining the maximum weight of commercial vehicles in order to prevent overloading thereof.

[0004] Further, vehicles may be prohibited from entering certain geographical areas or travelling along certain routes based on their weight. For example, some motorways cross bridges that have weight limits that may not be suitable for vehicles carrying a heavy load.

[0005] As will also be appreciated, the weight of a vehicle may also affect its fuel economy. For example, a heavier vehicle may require more fuel to travel the same distance as a similar, lighter vehicle, which is not only more expensive but may also subject the heavier vehicle to regulations that require a specific minimum fuel economy.

[0006] It therefore may be useful to know the weight of a vehicle. However, the standard methods of measuring the weight of a vehicle may be inaccessible, difficult, expensive, and/or inaccurate. For example, one common method of weighing a vehicle involves the use of an external weighing device such as a truck scale or a weighbridge. However, such external weighing devices may not always be accessible and cannot measure the weight of a vehicle during operation—i.e., when the vehicle is in motion. Another method of weighing a vehicle involves the use of load sensors installed in the vehicle. However, as will be appreciated, the installation of such load sensors is generally difficult and expensive.

[0007] Thus, there is a need for improved systems and methods for determining the weight of a vehicle that are readily accessible while also being useable without difficult, expensive installations.

SUMMARY

[0008] In one aspect, the present disclosure relates to a method for determining an estimated weight of a vehicle. The method comprises operating at least one processor to: receive vehicle data associated with the vehicle, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of vehicle parameters collected during operation of the vehicle; identify one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data, each vehicle maneuver being associated with a portion of the vehicle data; and use at least one machine learning model to determine the estimated weight of the vehicle based on the portion of the vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the at least one

machine learning model trained using training data associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.

[0009] According to an embodiment, each portion of the vehicle data comprises geospatial data, vehicle engine data, or a combination thereof from a duration of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0010] According to a further embodiment, each portion of the vehicle data comprises a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof. In a further embodiment, the change in speed over a selected subsection of time is a change in speed over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers. In a further embodiment, the change in elevation over a selected subsection of time is a change in elevation over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0011] According to an embodiment, the training data comprises a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof, from a duration of the plurality previous vehicle maneuvers. In a further embodiment, the change in speed over a selected subsection of time is a change in speed over a first 3 second interval of each of the plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers. In a further embodiment, the change in elevation over a selected subsection of time is a change in elevation over a first 3 second interval of each of the plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.

[0012] According to an embodiment, the at least one machine learning model comprises a supervised learning model, a semi-supervised learning model, an unsupervised learning model, or a combination thereof. In a further embodiment, the at least one machine learning model comprises a Random Forest model, an AutoEncoder, an AutoInt model, a Tabnet model, or a combination thereof.

[0013] According to an embodiment, each vehicle maneuver and each previous vehicle maneuver comprises an acceleration maneuver.

[0014] According to an embodiment, the determining of the estimated weight of the vehicle using the at least one machine learning model comprises determining a load state of the vehicle. In a further embodiment, a plurality of load states are determined based on the portions of vehicle data associated with a plurality of vehicle maneuvers. In a yet further embodiment, the method further comprises operating the at least one processor to determine an overall load state of the vehicle based on the plurality of load states. In a yet further embodiment, the determining of the overall load state of the vehicle comprises averaging or aggregating the plurality of load states. In a still further embodiment, each of the portions of vehicle data comprises a measured vehicle parameter profile; and the method further comprises operating the at least one processor to: receive a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles for one or more of the previous vehicle maneuvers, generate a plurality of error profiles for each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers based on differences between the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles and the measured vehicle parameter profile, and determine an estimated weight value of the vehicle by minimizing, averaging, or a combination thereof the plurality of error profiles. In a yet further embodiment, the measured vehicle condition profile comprises a measured torque profile and the plurality of simulated vehicle condition profiles comprise simulated torque profiles.

[0015] According to an embodiment, the determining of the estimated weight of the vehicle using the at least one machine learning model comprises determining an estimated weight value of the vehicle. In a further embodiment, a plurality of estimated weight values are determined based on the portions of vehicle data associated with a plurality of vehicle maneuvers. In a yet further embodiment, the method further comprises operating the at least one processor to determine an

overall estimated weight value of the vehicle based on the plurality of estimated weight values. In a yet further embodiment, the determining of the overall estimated weight value of the vehicle comprises averaging or aggregating the plurality of estimated weight values.

[0016] According to an embodiment, the received vehicle data is curve-logged, interpolated vehicle data.

[0017] In a further aspect, the present disclosure relates to a system for determining an estimated weight of a vehicle. The system comprises at least one data storage configured to store vehicle data associated with the vehicle, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of vehicle parameters collected during operation of the vehicle. The system also comprises at least one processor in communication with the at least one data storage. The at least one processor is configured to identify one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data, each vehicle maneuver being associated with a portion of the vehicle data; and use at least one machine learning model to determine the estimated weight of the vehicle based on the portion of the vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the at least one machine learning model trained using training data associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.

[0018] According to an embodiment, each portion of the vehicle data comprises geospatial data, vehicle engine data, or a combination thereof from a duration of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0019] According to an embodiment, each portion of the vehicle data comprises a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof. In a further embodiment, the change in speed over a selected subsection of time is a change in speed over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers. In a further embodiment, the change in elevation over a selected subsection of time is a change in elevation over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0020] According to an embodiment, the training data comprises a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof, from a duration of the plurality previous vehicle maneuvers. In a further embodiment, the change in speed over a selected subsection of time is a change in speed over a first 3 second interval of each of the plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers. In a further embodiment, the change in elevation over a selected subsection of time is a change in elevation over a first 3 second interval of each of the plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.

[0021] According to an embodiment, the at least one machine learning model comprises a supervised learning model, a semi-supervised learning model, an unsupervised learning model, or a combination thereof. In a further embodiment, the at least one machine learning model comprises a Random Forest model, an AutoEncoder, an AutoInt model, a Tabnet model, or a combination thereof.

[0022] According to an embodiment, each vehicle maneuver and each previous vehicle maneuver comprises an acceleration maneuver.

[0023] According to an embodiment, the determining of the estimated weight of the vehicle using the at least one machine learning model comprises determining a load state of the vehicle. In a further embodiment, a plurality of load states are determined based on the portions of vehicle data associated with a plurality of vehicle maneuvers. In a yet further embodiment, the at least one processor is configured to determine an overall load state of the vehicle based on the plurality of load states. In a yet further embodiment, the overall load state of the vehicle is determined averaging or aggregating the plurality of load states. In a still further embodiment, each of the portions of vehicle data comprises a measured vehicle parameter profile; and the at least one

processor is configured to: receive a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles for one or more of the previous vehicle maneuvers, generate a plurality of error profiles for each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers based on differences between the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles and the measured vehicle parameter profile, and determine an estimated weight value of the vehicle by minimizing, averaging, or a combination thereof the plurality of error profiles. In a yet further embodiment, the measured vehicle condition profile comprises a measured torque profile and the plurality of simulated vehicle condition profiles comprise simulated torque profiles. [0024] According to an embodiment, the determining of the estimated weight of the vehicle using the at least one machine learning model comprises determining an estimated weight value of the vehicle. In a further embodiment, a plurality of estimated weight values are determined based on the portions of vehicle data associated with a plurality of vehicle maneuvers. In a yet further embodiment, the at least one processor is configured to determine an overall estimated weight value of the vehicle based on the plurality of estimated weight values. In a yet further embodiment, the overall estimated weight value of the vehicle is determined by averaging or aggregating the plurality of estimated weight values.

[0025] According to an embodiment, the received vehicle data is curve-logged, interpolated vehicle data.

[0026] In a yet further aspect, the present disclosure relates to a method of training at least one machine learning model, the method comprising operating at least one processor to: receive vehicle data associated with one or more vehicles, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of portions of vehicle data that are each associated with a vehicle maneuver and that each comprise a measured vehicle parameter profile; receive a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles for at least one measured vehicle parameter profile; generate a plurality of error profiles based on differences between each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles and the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles; determine, using the plurality of error profiles, an estimated vehicle weight associated with each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles; input the plurality of portions of vehicle data into the at least one machine learning model to thereby train the at least one machine learning model to estimate a weight of a vehicle using the vehicle data associated therewith.

[0027] According to an embodiment, each portion of the vehicle data comprises geospatial data, vehicle engine data, or a combination thereof from a duration of the vehicle maneuver. In a further embodiment, each portion of the vehicle data comprises a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof. In a yet further embodiment, the change in speed over a selected subsection of time is a change in speed over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers. In a yet further embodiment, the change in elevation over a selected subsection of time is a change in elevation over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0028] According to an embodiment, the at least one machine learning model comprises a supervised machine learning model, a semi-supervised machine learning model, or a combination thereof. In a further embodiment, the at least one machine learning model comprises a Random Forest model, an AutoEncoder model, an AutoInt model, a Tabnet model, or a combination thereof.

[0029] According to an embodiment, the estimated vehicle weight associated with each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles is an estimated vehicle load state and/or an estimated vehicle weight value.

[0030] According to an embodiment, each measured vehicle parameter profile comprises a measured torque profile and each of the simulated vehicle parameter profiles comprises a simulated torque profile.

[0031] According to an embodiment, the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles are

received for each measured vehicle parameter profile.

[0032] According to an embodiment, the determining of the estimated vehicle weight associated with each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles comprises minimizing, averaging, or a combination thereof the plurality of error profiles.

[0033] According to an embodiment, the determining of the estimated vehicle weight associated with each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles comprises determining an error associated with the estimated vehicle weight. In a further embodiment, each of the portions of vehicle data input into the at least one machine learning model comprise a measured vehicle parameter profile associated with an estimated weight having an error of less than 25%.

[0034] In a yet further aspect, the present disclosure related to a method of training at least one machine learning model, the method comprising operating at least one processor to: receive vehicle data associated with one or more vehicles, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of portions of vehicle data that are each associated with a vehicle maneuver and that each comprise a measured vehicle parameter profile comprising a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, and a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof; and input the plurality of portions of vehicle data into the at least one machine learning model to thereby train the at least one machine learning model to estimate a weight of a vehicle using the vehicle data associated therewith.

[0035] According to an embodiment, the change in speed over a selected subsection of time is a change in speed over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0036] According to an embodiment, the change in elevation over a selected subsection of time is a change in elevation over a first 3 second interval of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0037] According to an embodiment, the at least one machine learning model comprises an unsupervised machine learning model.

[0038] In a yet further aspect, the present disclosure relates to a non-transitory computer readable medium having instructions stored thereon executable by at least one processor to implement a method for determining an estimated weight of a vehicle. The implementable method comprises operating the at least one processor to: receive vehicle data associated with the vehicle, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of vehicle parameters collected during operation of the vehicle; identify one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data, each vehicle maneuver being associated with a portion of the vehicle data; and use at least one machine learning model to determine the estimated weight of the vehicle based on the portion of the vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the at least one machine learning model trained using training data associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.

[0039] Other aspects and features of the present disclosure will become apparent to those ordinarily skilled in the art upon review of the following description of specific embodiments.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0040] These and other features of the present disclosure will become more apparent in the following detailed description in which reference is made to the appended drawings. The appended drawings illustrate one or more embodiments of the present disclosure by way of example only and are not to be construed as limiting the scope of the present disclosure.

[0041] FIG. 1 is a block diagram of various components interacting with an example fleet management system and a plurality of telematic devices according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0042] FIG. 2 is a block diagram of the fleet management system shown in FIG. 1 interacting with one of the telematics devices and vehicles shown in FIG. 1 according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0043] FIG. 3 is a flowchart of an example method for determining an estimated weight of a vehicle according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0044] FIG. 4A is a graph of example speed data containing a plurality of example measured speed profiles according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0045] FIG. 4B is a graph of example torque data containing a plurality of example measured torque profiles according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0046] FIG. 5A is a flowchart of a simplified example of a Random Forest machine learning model.

[0047] FIG. 5B is a flowchart of a simplified example of an AutoInt machine learning model.

[0048] FIG. 5C is a flowchart of a simplified example of a AutoEncoder+Random Forest machine learning model.

[0049] FIG. 5D is a flowchart of a simplified example of an AutoInt+TabNet machine learning model.

[0050] FIG. 6 is a block diagram of an example vehicle dynamics model according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0051] FIG. 7A is a graph of an example measured torque profile according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0052] FIG. 7B is a plurality of graphs of a plurality of example simulated torque profiles corresponding to a plurality of example candidate vehicle weights according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0053] FIG. 8 is a graph of a plurality of example error profiles according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0054] FIG. 9 is a flowchart of an example method of training at least one machine learning model according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

[0055] FIG. 10 is a flowchart of an example method for determining an estimated weight and load state of a vehicle according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0056] As discussed herein, conventional methods for weighing vehicles involve the use of external weighing devices such as truck scales or weighbridges, or the use of vehicle-installed weighing devices such as load sensors. However, the conventional methods for weighing vehicles have a number of drawbacks, including inaccessibility of external weighing devices as well as the difficulty of, and the costs associated with, the installation of the vehicle-installed weighing devices.

[0057] Thus, it is an objective of the present disclosure to provide advantageous systems and methods for determining an estimated weight of a vehicle. For example, the systems and methods may advantageously be able to estimate the weight of a vehicle during operation. In more detail, the systems and methods of the present disclosure may be able to estimate the weight of a vehicle in motion and in real-time, without requiring the vehicle to stop onto, for example, a truck scale or weighbridge.

[0058] Further, the systems and methods of the present disclosure may advantageously estimate the weight of a vehicle using various data associated therewith (i.e., vehicle data) that is produced during the normal operation of the vehicle. In more detail, vehicles may produce vehicle data including information, parameters, attributes, characteristics, and/or features associated with the operation thereof during regular use. The vehicle data may include location data, speed data, acceleration data, engine data, fluid level data (e.g., oil, coolant, and/or washer fluid level data), energy data (e.g., battery or fuel level data), etc. As will be described herein, such vehicle data is generally readily accessible. In contrast, conventional methods may require the use of vehicle data

not produced during normal operation of the vehicle, which data is generally not accessible and may require the installation of specialized devices to collect. For example, conventional methods may involve the installation of load sensors to estimate vehicle weight, which may be difficult and expensive to install.

[0059] Furthermore, in some embodiments, the vehicle data used by the systems and methods of the present disclosure may advantageously be collected through a readily available and/or installable device such as a telematics device. As will be appreciated, telematics devices may collect the vehicle data for processing either by the telematics devices themselves or by one or more external devices and/or systems. The telematics device may be a pre-installed device (e.g., by the Original Equipment Manufacturer or “OEM”) or a standalone telematics device (e.g., an aftermarket device), which may be readily installable via an ODB-II (on-board diagnostics) port and/or CAN bus (controller area network) port. In contrast, as described herein, conventional methods for determining a vehicle weight may involve the installation of a load sensor, which is not installable via readily accessible ports such as ODB-II ports and/or CAN bus ports, and generally has to be securely mounted between the frame under a vehicle and an axle thereof.

[0060] Additional advantages will be discussed below and will be readily apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art reading the present disclosure.

[0061] Reference will now be made in detail to example embodiments of the present disclosure, wherein numerals refer to like components, examples of which are illustrated in the accompanying drawings that further show example embodiments, without limitation.

[0062] Referring now to FIG. 1, there is shown an example of a fleet management system **110** for managing a plurality of vehicles **120** equipped with a plurality of telematics devices **130**. Each of the telematics devices **130** is capable of collecting various vehicle data from the vehicles **120** and sharing the vehicle data with the fleet management system **110**. The fleet management system **110** may be remotely located from the telematics devices **130** and the vehicles **120**.

[0063] As will be appreciated, the vehicles **120** may include any type of vehicle. For example, the vehicles **120** may include motor vehicles such as cars, trucks (e.g., pickup trucks, heavy-duty trucks such as class-8 vehicles, etc.), motorcycles, industrial vehicles (e.g., buses), and the like. Each motor vehicle may be a gas, diesel, electric, hybrid, and/or alternative fuel vehicle. Further, the vehicles **120** may include vehicles such as railed vehicles (e.g., trains, trams, and streetcars), watercraft (e.g., ships and recreational pleasure craft), aircraft (e.g., airplanes and helicopters), spacecraft, and the like. Each of the vehicles **120** may be equipped with one of the telematics devices **130**.

[0064] In some embodiments, the telematics devices **130** may be standalone devices that are removably installed in the vehicles **120** (e.g., aftermarket telematics devices). In other embodiments, the telematics devices **130** may be integrated components of the vehicles **120** (e.g., pre-installed by an OEM). The telematics devices **130** may collect various vehicle data and share the vehicle data with the fleet management system **110**. As discussed herein, the vehicle data may include any information, parameters, attributes, characteristics, and/or features associated with the vehicles **120**. For example, the vehicle data may include geospatial data, engine data, or a combination thereof. In more detail, the vehicle data may include, but is not limited to, location data, speed data, acceleration data, fluid level data (e.g., oil, coolant, and washer fluid), energy data (e.g., battery and/or fluid level), or a combination thereof.

[0065] Once received, the fleet management system **110** may process the vehicle data collected from the telematics devices **130** to provide various analysis and reporting. In some embodiments, the fleet management system **110** may process the vehicle data to provide additional information about the vehicles **120** such as trip distances and times, idling times, harsh braking and driving, usage rates, fuel economy, etc. As will be discussed in greater detail below, various data analytics and machine learning models may be implemented to process the vehicle data. The vehicle data may then be used to manage various aspects of the vehicles **120**, such as route planning, vehicle

maintenance, driver compliance, asset utilization, fuel management, and the like, which, in turn, may improve productivity, efficiency, safety, and/or sustainability of the vehicles **120**.

[0066] A plurality of computing devices **150** may provide access to the fleet management system **110** to a plurality of users **160**. The users **160** may use computing devices **150** to access or retrieve various vehicle data collected and/or process by the fleet management system **110**. As will be appreciated, the computing devices **150** may be any suitable computing devices. For example, the computing devices **150** may be personal computers, portable computers, wearable computers, workstations, desktops, laptops, smartphones, tablets, smartwatches, personal digital assistants (PDAs), mobile devices, or the like. The computing devices **150** may be remotely located from the fleet management system **110**, telematic devices **130**, and vehicles **120**.

[0067] The fleet management system **110**, telematics devices **130**, and computing devices **150** may communicate through a network **140**. The network **140** may comprise a plurality of networks and may be wireless, wired, or a combination thereof. As will be appreciated, the network **140** may employ any suitable communication protocol and may use any suitable communication medium. For example, the network **140** may comprise Wi-Fi™ networks, Ethernet networks, Bluetooth™ networks, near-field communication (NFC) networks, radio networks, cellular networks, and/or satellite networks. The network **140** may be public, private, or a combination thereof. For example, the network **140** may comprise local area networks (LANs), wide area networks (WANs), the internet, or a combination thereof. Of course, as will also be appreciated, the network **140** may also facilitate communication with other devices and/or systems that are not shown.

[0068] Referring now to FIG. 2, there is illustrated the fleet management system **110** in communication with one of the telematics devices **130** that is installed in one of the vehicles **120**. As shown, the fleet management system **110** may include a processor **112**, a data storage **114**, and a communication interface **116**, each of which may communicate with each other. The processor **112**, the data storage **114**, and the communication interface **116** may be combined into fewer components, divided into additional subcomponents, or a combination thereof. The components and/or subcomponents may not necessarily be distributed in proximity to one another and may instead be distributed across a wide geographical area. In some embodiments, the fleet management system **110** may be implemented using a cloud computing system.

[0069] The processor **112** may control the operation of the fleet management system **110**. As will be appreciated, the processor **112** may be implemented using one or more suitable processing devices. For example, the processor **112** may be implemented using central processing units (CPUs), graphics processing units (GPUs), field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs), application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), digital signal processors (DSPs), neural processing units (NPU), quantum processing units (QPU), microprocessors, controllers, and the like. The processor **112** may execute various instructions, programs, software, or a combination thereof stored on the data storage **114** to implement various methods described herein. For example, the processor **112** may process various vehicle data collected by the fleet management system **110** from the telematics devices **130**.

[0070] Various data for the fleet management system **110** may be stored on the data storage **114**. The data storage **114** may be implemented using one or more suitable data storage devices or systems such as random-access memory (RAM), read only memory (ROM), flash memory, hard disk drives (HDDs), solid-state drives (SSDs), magnetic tape drives, optical disc drives, memory cards, and the like. The data storage **114** may include volatile memory, non-volatile memory, or a combination thereof. Further, the data storage **114** may comprise non-transitory computer readable media. The data storage **114** may store various instructions, programs, and/or software that are executable by the processor **112** to implement various methods described herein. The data storage **114** may store various vehicle data collected from the telematics devices **130** and/or processed by the processor **112**.

[0071] The communication interface **116** may enable communication between the fleet

management system **110** and other devices and/or systems, such as the telematics devices **130**. The communication interface **116** may be implemented using any suitable communications devices and/or systems. For example, the communication interface **116** may comprise one or more various physical connectors, ports, or terminals such as universal serial bus (USB), ethernet, Thunderbolt, Firewire, serial advanced technology attachment (SATA), peripheral component interconnect (PCI), high-definition multimedia interface (HDMI), DisplayPort, and the like. As another example, the communication interface **116** may comprise one or more wireless interface components to connect to wireless networks such as Wi-Fi™, Bluetooth™, NFC, cellular, satellite, and the like. The communication interface **116** may enable various inputs and outputs to be received at and sent from the fleet management system **110**. For example, the communication interface **116** may be used to retrieve vehicle data from the telematics devices **130**.

[0072] The telematics devices **130** may include a processor **134**, a data storage **134**, and a communication interface **136**. The telematics devices **130** may also comprise a sensor **138**. Each of the components of the telematics devices **130** may communicate with each other and may be combined into fewer components or divided into additional subcomponents.

[0073] The processor **132** may control the operation of the telematics device **130**. The processor **132** may be implemented using any suitable processing devices or systems, such as those described above in relation to the processor **112** of the fleet management system **110**. The processor **132** may execute various instructions, programs, software, or a combination thereof stored on the data storage **134** to implement various methods described herein. For example, the processor **132** may process various vehicle data collected from vehicle components **122** and/or the sensor **138**.

[0074] The data storage **134** may store various data for the telematics device **130**. The data storage **134** may be any suitable data storage device or system, such as those described above in relation to the data storage **114** of the fleet management system **110**. The data storage **134** may store various instructions, programs, software, or a combination thereof executable by the processor **132** to implement various methods described herein. As well, the data storage **134** may store various vehicle data collected from the vehicle components **122** and/or the sensor **138**.

[0075] The communication interface **136** may enable communication between the telematics devices **130** and other devices or systems, such as the fleet management system **110** and the vehicle components **122**. The communication interface **136** may comprise any suitable communication devices or systems, such as those described above in relation to the communication interface **116** of the fleet management system **110**. The communication interface **136** may enable various inputs and outputs to be received at and sent from the telematics devices **130**. For example, the communication interface **136** may be used to collect vehicle data from the vehicle components **122** and/or sensor **138**, to send vehicle data to the fleet management system **110**, etc.

[0076] The sensor **138** may detect and/or measure various environmental events, changes, etc. The sensor **138** may comprise any suitable sensing devices or systems, such as, but not limited to, location sensors, velocity sensors, acceleration sensors, orientation sensors, vibration sensors, proximity sensors, temperature sensors, humidity sensors, pressure sensors, optical sensors, audio sensors, and combinations thereof. When the telematics device **130** is installed in the vehicle **120**, the sensor **138** may be used to collect vehicle data that may not be obtainable from the vehicle components **122**. For example, the sensor **138** may include a satellite navigation device such as a global positioning system (GPS) receiver that may measure the location of the vehicle **120**. In some embodiments, the sensor **138** may comprise accelerometers, gyroscopes, magnetometers, inertial measurement units (IMUs), or the like that may measure the acceleration and/or orientation of the vehicle **120**.

[0077] The telematics device **130** may be installed within the vehicle **120** removably or integrally. The vehicle **120** may include the vehicle components **122** and a vehicle interface **124**, which, as will be appreciated, may be combined into fewer components or divided into additional subcomponents. In some embodiments, the vehicle components **122** may comprise any subsystems,

parts, subcomponents, or combinations thereof of the vehicle **120**. For example, the vehicle components **122** may comprise powertrains, engines, transmissions, steering, braking, seating, batteries, doors, suspensions, etc. The telematics device **130** may collect vehicle data from the vehicle components **122**. For example, in some embodiments, the telematics device **130** may communicate with one or more electrical control units (ECUs) that control the vehicle components **122** or one or more internal sensors thereof.

[0078] The vehicle interface **124** may facilitate communication between the vehicle components **122** and other devices or systems. As well, the vehicle interface **124** may comprise any suitable communication devices or systems. For example, the vehicle interface **124** may comprise an OBD-II port and/or CAN bus port. The vehicle interface **124** may be used by the telematics device **130** to collect vehicle data from the vehicle components **122**. For example, the communication interface **136** may be connected to the vehicle interface **124** to communicate with the vehicle components **122**.

[0079] Referring now to FIG. 3, there is shown an example method **300** for determining an estimated weight of a vehicle according to the present disclosure. As shown, the method **300** may comprise receiving vehicle data (**302**), identifying one or more vehicle maneuvers that are each associated with a portion of the vehicle data (**304**), and using at least one machine learning model to determine an estimated weight of a vehicle based on the portion of the vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers (**306**). As will be appreciated, the method **300** may be implemented using any suitable systems and/or devices, such as those illustrated in FIG. 1 and FIG. 2. For example, the method **300** may be implemented by the fleet management system **110**, one or more of the telematics devices **130**, or a combination thereof. In more detail, the method **300** may be implemented by operating at least one processor of the fleet management system **110** and/or telematics devices **130**, such as the processor **112** and/or the processor **132**, to execute instructions stored on the data storage **114** and/or the data storage **134**.

[0080] In embodiments where the method **300** is implemented by the fleet management system **110** (i.e., remote from the telematics device **130** and vehicle **120**), less data processing may be completed at the telematics devices **130**. As a result, the hardware complexity of the telematics devices **130** may be reduced, which, in turn, may lower the cost to produce the telematics devices **130**. As well, it may be easier to update and/or modify software running on the fleet management system **110** as compared to a telematics device **130** that has already been installed in the vehicle **120**. However, in embodiments where the method **300** is implemented at the telematics devices **130** (i.e., remote from the fleet management system **110**), less data may be transmitted to the fleet management system **110**, thereby reducing network usage and bandwidth on the network **140**. As will be appreciated, usage costs associated with the network **140** may in turn also be reduced. Thus, the method **300** may be implemented in a variety of ways and each implementation may have advantages associated therewith.

[0081] As shown in FIG. 3 at **302**, vehicle data associated with a vehicle (e.g., the vehicle **120**) may be received. For example, in the context of the devices and systems described herein, the telematics device **130** may receive vehicle data from the sensor **138**, vehicle components **122**, or a combination thereof. Alternatively, or additionally, the fleet management system **110** may receive vehicle data from the telematics device **130**. Alternatively, or additionally, the processor **112** and/or the processor **132** may receive vehicle data from the data storage **114** and/or the data storage **134**.

[0082] The vehicle data may comprise a plurality of vehicle parameters collected during operation of the vehicle **120**. As described herein, the vehicle data may include any information, parameters, attributes, characteristics, and/or features associated with the vehicle **120** and may vary depending on, for example, the intended uses therefor. Non-limiting examples of vehicle data that may be collected include geospatial data and engine data. As described herein, geospatial data may include, but is not limited to, speed data, acceleration data, elevation data, location data, and the like. Engine data may include, but is not limited to, torque data, gear ratio data, gear change data,

rotational data, and the like.

[0083] Speed data may represent the velocity, or rate of locational change, of the vehicle **120**. Speed data may be obtained from a vehicle speed sensor (VSS), for example, located in the powertrain and/or ABS of the vehicle **120**. Alternatively, or additionally, the speed data may be calculated based on changes in location data over time, for example, obtained by the sensor **138**.

[0084] Acceleration data may indicate the acceleration, or the rate of change of speed, of the vehicle **120**. The acceleration data may be obtained from an accelerometer of the vehicle **120** or the telematics device **130** (e.g., sensor **138**). Alternatively, the acceleration data may be calculated based on the speed data. In more detail, the acceleration data may be determined using the following equation (where v_2 is the velocity of the vehicle at time t_2 , and v_1 is the velocity of the vehicle **120** at time t_1):

[00001] $\text{acceleration} = \frac{v_2 - v_1}{t_2 - t_1}$ [0085] Location data may indicate the geographical location of the vehicle **120**. Location data may be obtained from, for example, a GPS receiver of the telematics device **130** (e.g., the sensor **138**) or the vehicle **120**. As will be appreciated, location data may indicate an exact or approximate location of a vehicle **120**, distances travelled by the vehicle, routes travelled by the vehicle **120**, and the like.

[0086] Elevation data may indicate the altitude, or distance above sea level, of the vehicle **120**. The elevation data may be calculated using location data, for example, obtained from the sensor **138**. In more detail, the elevation data may be determined by correlating the location data with topographic data. Alternatively, the elevation data may be obtained from an altimeter of the telematic device **130** (e.g., the sensor **138**) or the vehicle **120**.

[0087] Torque data may represent the rotational force output of the vehicle **120**. As will be appreciated, the torque data may be in units of torque and/or a percentage of maximum torque. The torque data may include engine torque data, representing the torque output of the engine of the vehicle **120**, and/or wheel torque data, representing the torque output at the wheels of the vehicle **120**. Engine torque data may be obtained from the engine of the vehicle **120**, for example, by an internal sensor, ECU, or a combination thereof. Wheel torque data may be calculated based on the engine torque data and gear ratio data. For example, wheel torque data may be determined using the following equation:

[00002] $\text{wheel torque} = \text{effective gear ratio} \times \text{engine torque}$

[0088] Gear ratio data may represent the effective gear ratio, or ratio between rate of rotational output at the engine and at the wheels, of the vehicle **120**. The gear ratio data may be calculated based on rotational or rpm data of the vehicle **120**. For example, the effective gear ratio may be determined using the following equation:

[00003] $\text{effective gear ratio} = \frac{\text{engine rpm}}{\text{wheel rpm}}$

[0089] Alternatively, the gear ratio data may be calculated based on the transmission ratio (ie) and differential ratio (id) of the vehicle **120**. In more detail, the effective gear ratio may be calculated using the following equation:

[00004] $\text{effective gear ratio} = i_e i_d$

[0090] As indicated herein, rotational data may represent the rotational speed, or rpm, generated by the vehicle **120**. The rotational data may include engine rotational data, representing the rpm of the engine, and/or wheel rotational data, representing the rpm of the wheels of the vehicle **120**.

[0091] The engine rotational data may be obtained from, for example, a crankshaft position sensor of the vehicle **120**, while wheel rotational data may be calculated using the speed data of the vehicle **120** and the circumference of the wheels. For example, the wheel rotational data may be obtained using the following equation:

[00005] $\text{wheel RPM} = \frac{\text{vehicle speed}}{\text{wheel circumference}}$

[0092] In some embodiments, the vehicle data may be preprocessed prior to and/or subsequently to being received. For example, the vehicle data may be received in one or more various formats,

standards, or protocols. In some cases, it may be beneficial to reformat the vehicle data prior to being used for weight estimation. As a further example, the vehicle data may include data points that correspond to irregular and/or mismatched points in time. In such situations, the vehicle data may be interpolated so that the data points in each time series correspond to successive and/or equally spaced points in time. As a yet further example, the vehicle data may be curve logged, which, as will be appreciated, may result in a reduced number of data points. In such configurations, the reduced number of data points may be interpolated to provide a fulsome dataset.

[0093] As shown in FIG. 3 at **304**, one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data may be identified. The one or more vehicle maneuvers may be identified by, for example, the fleet management system **110** (e.g., the processor **112**), the telematics device **130** (e.g., the processor **132**), or a combination thereof. Each vehicle maneuver may be associated with a portion of the vehicle data. For example, each vehicle maneuver may be associated with a portion of vehicle data comprising geospatial data, engine data, or a combination thereof. As described herein, the geospatial and/or engine data may include, but are not limited to, speed data, acceleration data, location data, elevation data, torque data, gear ratio data, gear change data, rotational data, etc. [0094] The one or more vehicle maneuvers may be identified based on the vehicle data. In more detail, vehicle maneuvers may be identified by identifying portions of the vehicle data that satisfy one or more predetermined conditions. The predetermined conditions may include the execution of various actions by the vehicle **120**. For example, the predetermined conditions may include, but are not limited to: vehicle propulsion, wherein the vehicle **120** is being actively propelled or driven; non-turning of the vehicle **120**, wherein the vehicle **120** travels in a substantially straight trajectory without turning; non-braking of the vehicle **120**, wherein the vehicle **120** is not actively braking or decelerating; changes in elevation of the vehicle **120**, wherein the elevation changes may be more or less than a predetermined value; the speed of the vehicle **120** being greater or less than a predetermined value; the effective gear ratio of the vehicle **120** being greater or less than a predetermined value; and the like. Thus, vehicle maneuvers may represent an action performed, or an event experienced, by the vehicle **120** (e.g., an acceleration maneuver, wherein the vehicle **120** is determined to be accelerating).

[0095] Referring now to FIG. 4A and FIG. 4B, example speed data **400** and example torque data **450** are shown, respectively. In the context of the present disclosure, vehicle data associated with a vehicle maneuver may be referred to generally as a vehicle parameter profile. Specific types of vehicle parameter profiles include, for example, speed profiles, torque profiles, etc. As shown, portions of the speed data **402** (i.e., measured speed profiles) and portions of the torque data **452** (i.e., measured torque profiles) may be identified as vehicle maneuvers. In the illustrated example, the vehicle maneuvers correspond to portions of the vehicle data received while the vehicle **120** was in acceleration (i.e., being actively propelled or driven). Various measured speed profiles **402** and measured torque profiles **452** that satisfy such conditions may be identified as vehicle maneuvers.

[0096] The types of vehicle maneuvers to be identified may be selected based on potential similarities or differences between the vehicle data of vehicles of different weights. For example, the vehicle data received from a 1,500 kg vehicle may differ significantly from that of a 3,000 kg vehicle during certain vehicle maneuvers. Further, the vehicle maneuvers may be selected to reduce the impact of certain variables on the received vehicle data. For example, by selecting acceleration maneuvers occurring between speeds of about 20 km/h to about 80 km/h, the impact of certain physical variables (e.g., gear-box drag coefficients) and/or environmental variables (e.g., wind resistance) may be reduced or mitigated.

[0097] As described herein, each identified vehicle maneuver has associated therewith a portion of vehicle data. As will be appreciated, each portion of vehicle data associated with an identified vehicle maneuver may include a plurality of vehicle data types. For example, referring to FIG. 4A and FIG. 4B, corresponding portions of speed data **402** and torque data **452** (i.e., speed and torque

data received during the same acceleration maneuver) may be included in the overall portion of vehicle data associated with the vehicle maneuver. That is, while an identified vehicle maneuver may be identified using a certain type of vehicle data, the portion of vehicle data associated with the identified vehicle maneuver may comprise other vehicle data received during the identified vehicle maneuver. The other data included in the portion of vehicle data may be used in the estimation of the weight of the vehicle.

[0098] As will be appreciated, each identified vehicle maneuver may differ in duration. As a result, it may in some cases be useful to normalize the portion of vehicle data associated with each identified vehicle maneuver. For example, for acceleration maneuvers, it may be useful to normalize the portions of vehicle data associated therewith by the distance traveled during the identified maneuvers. That is, the portions of vehicle data may be divided by the distance travelled during the identified acceleration maneuvers to provide normalized portions of vehicle data. Of course, other normalization techniques are possible and are contemplated. Thus, in some embodiments, the identifying of the one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data may further comprise normalizing each portion of vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0099] Further, it may in some cases be desirable to filter identified vehicle maneuvers. In more detail, while vehicle maneuvers may be identified by meeting one or more predetermined conditions, it may be useful to remove one or more of the identified maneuvers that may not provide useful information. For example, while an acceleration maneuver may be identified for the vehicle **120** based on the vehicle data thereof, it may be the case that the speed of the vehicle **120** was increasing due to the vehicle travelling downhill rather than the operation of the engine thereof. As a result, the other data included in the portion of vehicle data associated with the identified vehicle maneuver may not be useful. Thus, in that example, acceleration maneuvers associated with a decrease in elevation and a comparatively low number of gear changes may be filtered out and not included in the methods and systems of determining an estimated vehicle weight described herein. As will be appreciated, suitable vehicle maneuver filters may comprise one or more predetermined thresholds that an identified vehicle maneuver must meet to be used in the systems and methods described herein. As well, a plurality of vehicle maneuver filters may be applied if so desired. Thus, in some embodiments, the identifying of the one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data may further comprise filtering the one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the portion of vehicle data associated therewith.

[0100] Referring back to FIG. **3**, as shown at **306**, the estimated weight of the vehicle may be determined. As described herein, each portion of data associated with the one or more vehicle maneuvers may include a variety of vehicle data received during each vehicle maneuver, which may be used to estimate the weight of the vehicle. In some embodiments, each portion of vehicle data may comprise geospatial data, vehicle engine data, or a combination thereof. As described herein, geospatial data may comprise, but is not limited to, speed data, acceleration data, elevation data, and location data. Vehicle engine data may comprise, but is not limited to, gear change data, torque data, gear ratio data, and rotational data.

[0101] A machine learning model may be used to determine an estimated weight of the vehicle based on each portion of vehicle data associated with the one or more vehicle maneuvers. The machine learning model may be any suitable model including, but not limited to, a supervised learning model, an unsupervised learning model, a semi-supervised learning model, a reinforcement learning model, a deep neural network, etc. Examples of suitable machine learning models include models such as Random Forest (RF), AutoInt, an Autoencoder (AE), Tabnet, an AE+RF model, a TabNet+AutoInt model, etc.

[0102] In more detail, as will be appreciated, a Random Forest (RF) model is an ensemble machine learning model that builds decision trees on random subsets of input data that are subsequently merged (e.g., by majority vote) to provide a predicted output. Generally, building uncorrelated

decision trees on random subsets of input data may be useful for reducing variance when predicting outcomes. For illustrative purposes, a simplified example of an RF model is shown in FIG. 5A. As shown, an RF model **500** includes a plurality of decision trees (indicated by “D”) that produce a prediction (in the illustrated example, either a “Y” for “yes” or a “N” for “no”). The predictions may then be aggregated, for example, by way of a majority vote to determine a predicted output.

[0103] An AutoInt model refers to a deep tabular machine learning model that is capable of automatically learning high-order interactions of input data. Generally, an AutoInt model operates by mapping numerical and/or categorical features into a low-dimensional space, after which a multi-head self-attentive neural network with residual connections models the data interactions in the low-dimensional space. Using a plurality of layers of the multi-head self-attentive neural network, a plurality of different orders of data combinations may be modeled. AutoInt models may include attention pooling at one or more of the layers of the multi-head self-attentive neural network so that single vector representations of data may be extracted. For illustrative purposes, an example of a simplified AutoInt model **510** is shown in FIG. 5B. As shown, data values and data embeddings (e.g., embedded, non-numerical data) may be input into the AutoInt model and subjected to a plurality of multi-head attention and feed-forward layers to produce an output. As also shown, attention pooling may be used at each layer of the model to extract, for example, a single vector from the data embeddings. The attention poolings may reduce the likelihood of the model overfitting the data and may result in faster data convergence by reducing the number of parameters the model has to learn.

[0104] AutoEncoder (AE) models generally refer to unsupervised feed-forward neural networks where the input data is the same as the output data. AE models are often used to reduce the noise and/or dimensionality of a dataset. Generally, an AE model may encode input data by compressing the input data into a lower-dimensional code (sometimes referred to as “latent variables”) and then reconstructing, or decoding, the encoded data from the lower-dimensional dataset. In the context of the present disclosure, an AE model may be combined with supervised machine learning models such as those described above. A simplified example of such a configuration is illustrated in FIG. 5C, which depicts an AE+RF model. As shown, an AE model **530** may feed the lower-dimensional code into the RF model **500**, which provides a predicted output.

[0105] TabNet models generally employ instance-wise sequential attention to select data at each decision step using deep learning architecture. As will be appreciated, TabNet models may use structured or tabular data as inputs and are capable of predicting uncorrupted outputs from corrupted inputs. As a result, TabNet models may also be used in conjunction with other models. One such example is illustrated in FIG. 5D, which depicts a TabNet+AutoInt model **540**. As shown, a TabNet encoder may be included in an AutoInt model to encode the data values and data embeddings prior to subjection to the multi-head attention and feed-forward layers of the AutoInt model.

[0106] The at least one machine learning model is trained using vehicle data (i.e., training data) associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers. The training data associated with the plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers may comprise portions of vehicle data associated with each of the previous vehicle maneuvers. As will be appreciated, the at least one machine learning model may be trained by using labelled training data, unlabelled training data, or a combination thereof associated with previous vehicle maneuvers. Generally, supervised machine learning models may be trained using labelled data, semi-supervised machine learning models may be trained using a combination of labelled and unlabelled data, and unsupervised machine learning models may be trained using unlabelled data. In the context of the present disclosure, labelled data may include vehicle data associated with an indication of vehicle weight (e.g., a measured vehicle weight or load state, a predicted vehicle weight or load state, etc.) while unlabelled data may include vehicle data that is not associated with any indication of vehicle weight.

[0107] The plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers may comprise previously identified vehicle

maneuvers. For example, prior to the implementation of the methods and systems of the present disclosure, the fleet management system **110** (e.g., the processor **112**), the telematics device **130** (e.g., the processor **112**), or a combination thereof may identify a plurality of vehicle maneuvers from a plurality of vehicles **120** using the techniques previously described herein, each of which has associated therewith a portion of vehicle data. The portions of vehicle data associated with the plurality of identified vehicle maneuvers may then be stored on, for example, the data storage **112**, the data storage **132**, one or more other data storages, or a combination thereof. The plurality of previously identified vehicle maneuvers will generally be the same type or types of vehicle maneuvers selected to be identified in the systems and methods of the present disclosure. For example, if acceleration maneuvers are to be identified, the previous vehicle maneuvers may comprise previously identified acceleration maneuvers. The stored portions of vehicle data associated with the identified vehicle maneuvers may then be input into the at least one machine learning model as training data to train the at least one machine learning model (e.g., prior to the implementation of the methods or systems of the present disclosure).

[0108] As described above, depending on the machine learning model or models used, it may be desirable to label at least a portion of the training data associated with the previous vehicle maneuvers prior to training the at least one machine learning model. As described herein, it may be useful to label the training data with an indication of the weight of the vehicle or vehicles performing the previously identified maneuvers. For example, a suitable label may include a predicted vehicle weight value or range, and/or an indication of the load state of the vehicle. The labelling of the training data may be completed manually or using computational methods. As will be appreciated, for large data sets, manual labelling may not be desirable.

[0109] Examples of suitable methods for labelling training data to be used for training the at least one machine learning model for use in the systems and methods of the present disclosure are discussed below. In one example, the fleet management system **110** (e.g., processor **112**) and/or telematics device **130** (e.g., processor **132**) may generate simulated vehicle parameter profiles using a vehicle dynamics model. As will be appreciated, the vehicle dynamics model may be any suitable model for simulating the operation of a vehicle. For example, the vehicle dynamics model may be a model generated using various modeling or simulation software such as MapleSim™, Simulink™, SystemModeler™, Dymola™, SimulationX™, and the like. As well, or alternatively, the vehicle dynamics model may be a functional mock-up unit (FMU) and/or a functional mock-up interface (FMI) that may interface with other software.

[0110] The vehicle dynamics model may generate the simulated vehicle parameter profiles based on various input data. The input data may include various vehicle data, other data, or a combination thereof. For example, the input data for each vehicle maneuver may include the portion of the vehicle data associated with the respective one or more vehicle maneuvers such as, but not limited to, geospatial data and/or engine data. The input data may also include a plurality of candidate vehicle weights. Each candidate vehicle weight may represent a presumed or putative weight of the vehicle. In such configurations, each simulated vehicle parameter profile may correspond to one of the candidate vehicle weights. Accordingly, each simulated vehicle parameter profile may represent a simulation or a prediction of the vehicle data that could be measured during a vehicle maneuver if the vehicle weight was the candidate vehicle weight.

[0111] An example is illustrated in FIG. 6, which depicts an example vehicle dynamics model **600**. As shown, the vehicle dynamics model may receive various input data **602** and generate simulated vehicle parameter profiles **604** (e.g., simulated speed profiles, simulated torque profiles, etc.) based on the input data **602**. In the illustrated example, the input data includes candidate vehicle weights, vehicle data, physical constants, and other model parameters. As described herein, the candidate vehicle weights may represent presumed or putative weights of the vehicle **120**. The vehicle data may include various vehicle data associated with the corresponding vehicle maneuvers, such as, but not limited to, measured geospatial and/or engine data. The physical constants may include various

physical coefficients, parameters, and/or constants that may be used by the vehicle dynamics model **600**, such as, but not limited to, wheel radii, vehicle cross-sectional dimensions, drag coefficients, roll coefficients, and the like. The other model parameters may include auxiliary or secondary parameters that are specific to the vehicle dynamics model **600**. For example, the other model parameters may include proportional integral derivative (PID) controller parameters that may be used to adjust the sensitivity of the vehicle dynamics model **600**.

[0112] FIG. 7A and FIG. 7B show, respectively, a measured vehicle parameter profile and a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles generated by the vehicle dynamics model **600** corresponding to a vehicle maneuver. In the illustrated example, the measured vehicle parameter profile is a measured torque profile **700A** and the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles are simulated torque profiles **700B**. However, as described herein, the measured and simulated vehicle parameter profiles may include any suitable vehicle data. As well, the measured and simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be associated with any desired vehicle maneuver. For example, in the illustrated embodiment, the measured torque profile **700A** and the simulated torque profiles **700B** are associated with an acceleration maneuver.

[0113] Using a measured vehicle parameter profile and one or more simulated vehicle parameter profiles, an error profile may be generated (e.g., by the processor **112** of the fleet management system **110** and/or by the processor **132** of the telematics device **130**) for the corresponding vehicle maneuver. An error profile may be generated for the vehicle maneuver based on differences between the measured vehicle parameter profile and the one or more simulated vehicle parameter profiles. For example, an error profile may be generated based on the differences between the measured torque profile **700A** and the plurality of simulated torque profiles **700B**.

[0114] Further, the simulated vehicle parameter profiles may correspond to one or more candidate vehicle weights. In the illustrated example, the simulated torque profiles **700B** correspond to a plurality of candidate vehicle weights (m_1 , m_2 , m_3). Each simulated torque profile may correspond to a different one of the candidate vehicle weights. For example, in the illustrated embodiment, a first simulated torque profile **702B** corresponds to a first candidate vehicle weight (m_1), a second simulated torque profile **704B** corresponds to a second candidate vehicle weight (m_2), and a third simulated torque profile **706B** corresponds to a third candidate vehicle weight (m_3). Thus, each error profile generated using the measured torque profile **700A** and each of the simulated torque profiles **700B** may represent the error of each candidate vehicle weight.

[0115] Referring now to FIG. 8, there is shown a plurality of example error profiles **800** for the measured torque profile **700A** and the simulated torque profiles **700B** for the associated vehicle maneuver. As shown, each error profile may correspond to a particular vehicle maneuver. For example, in the illustrated embodiment, a first error profile **810** corresponds to a first vehicle maneuver (maneuver **1**), a second error profile **820** corresponds to a second vehicle maneuver (maneuver **2**), and a third error profile **830** corresponds to a third vehicle maneuver (maneuver **3**). As described herein, since each simulated torque profile **700B** may correspond to a particular candidate weight, each error profile **800** may represent the error of each candidate vehicle weight for a particular vehicle maneuver.

[0116] The differences between the simulated torque profiles **700B** and the measured torque profiles **700A** may be determined using any suitable technique. For example, the differences may correspond to differences between the area under the curve of each of the simulated torque profiles **700B** and the area under the curve of the measured torque profile **700A**. The differences may be the mean square error of the differences of the respective areas under the curves. An advantage of determining the differences in this manner is that noise and/or other errors in the vehicle parameter profiles may have less of an effect on the area under the curve as compared to the vehicle parameter profile itself.

[0117] Once determined, the error profiles may be used to provide a predicted vehicle weight. For example, the error profiles may be minimized and/or averaged to predict a candidate vehicle weight

for a vehicle maneuver with a lowest associated error. In more detail, as shown in FIG. 8, each error profile **800** may have a minimum that corresponds to a particular candidate vehicle weight. In the illustrated example, a first error profile **810** has a minimum **812**, a second error profile **820** has a minimum **822**, and a third error profile **830** has a minimum **832**. The candidate vehicle weights that minimize the error profiles **800** (i.e., at minimums **812**, **822**, and **832**) may be identified and used to predict the weight of the vehicle **120**. Thus, each error profile **800** may represent a grid search for a candidate vehicle weight that minimizes the error between the simulated torque profiles **700B** and the measured torque profiles **700A**.

[0118] Once identified, the candidate vehicle weights that minimize the error profiles may be averaged to provide a predicted vehicle weight. In more detail, and with reference to the illustrated example, the candidate vehicle weights corresponding to the minimums **812**, **822**, and **832** may be averaged to determine a predicted weight of the vehicle. In some embodiments, the average of the candidate vehicle weights may be a weighted average, wherein the candidate vehicle weights may be assigned different weights based on the corresponding error profile. For example, the candidate vehicle weights may be weighted based on a sensitivity of the corresponding error profiles **800**. The sensitivity of an error profile **800** may correspond to the slope or rate of change of that error profile **800**. An error profile with a greater slope may be considered more sensitive than an error profile having a lower slope because a greater slope may represent a large change in error in response to a small change in candidate vehicle weight. Candidate vehicle weights corresponding to error profiles **800** having greater sensitivity may be given more weight than candidate vehicle weights corresponding to error profiles **800** having lower sensitivity. For example, the candidate vehicle weight identified from error profile **820** may be assigned greater weight than the candidate vehicle weights identified from error profiles **810** and **830**.

[0119] The predicted vehicle weight for the previous vehicle maneuvers determined using the error profiles may then be used as a label for training data to direct the at least one machine learning model to associate the vehicle data of a particular vehicle maneuver with a particular vehicle weight. In some embodiments, the previous vehicle maneuvers selected for use as training data are labelled with a predicted weight having an error less than a particular maximum. For example, the previous vehicle maneuvers used to train the at least one machine learning model may be labelled with a predicted vehicle weight having an error less than 25%, 20%, 15%, 10%, 5%, etc. Such embodiments may be useful, as previous vehicle maneuvers having predicted vehicle weights with relatively less error may indicate a more accurate training dataset. As will be appreciated, the level of error selected to be acceptable may depend at least in part on the size of the previous vehicle maneuver dataset available.

[0120] As described above, the previous vehicle maneuvers may also or alternatively be labelled with a load state prior to use as training data for the at least one machine learning model. In the context of the present disclosure, the load state of a vehicle is an indication of whether the vehicle is loaded with cargo. The load state of a vehicle may also indicate whether the vehicle is excessively loaded (or “overloaded”). For the previous vehicle maneuvers, the load state of the vehicle that performed the maneuvers may be predicted using a predicted weight therefor. For example, if the weight of a vehicle **120** is predicted to be above a predetermined weight threshold (e.g., using the techniques described herein), the vehicle **120** may be considered to be loaded. If the weight of the vehicle **120** is predicted not to be above the predetermined weight threshold, the vehicle **120** may be considered to be unloaded. In some embodiments, the predetermined weight threshold may comprise a plurality of predetermined thresholds. For example, if the vehicle **120** is predicted to have a weight that exceeds both a first and a second predetermined weight threshold, the vehicle may be considered to be overloaded. Thus, examples of suitable labels for training data associated with the previous vehicle maneuvers include labels such as “unloaded”, “loaded”, and “overloaded”.

[0121] As described herein, the training data used to train the at least one machine learning model

may comprise portions of vehicle data associated with the previous vehicle maneuvers. The portions of vehicle data associated with the previous vehicle maneuvers may comprise vehicle data used to identify the previous vehicle maneuvers (e.g., prior to the implementation of the systems and methods of the present disclosure) as well as vehicle data that may be used to determine an estimated weight of the vehicle. For example, in embodiments where at least a portion of the training data is labelled, the portions of vehicle data may include types of vehicle data that inform the at least one machine learning model to estimate the weight of the vehicle, such as, but not limited to, vehicle data that is relevant to the type of vehicle maneuver identified, that is correlated to the label (e.g., negatively or positively correlated), that discriminates outliers, etc.

[0122] In more detail, the training data may comprise geospatial data, vehicle engine data, or a combination thereof from a duration of the one or more previous vehicle maneuvers. Examples of particular types of vehicle data that the training data may comprise include rotational data, torque data, energy data, speed data, elevation data, acceleration data, gear data, or a combination thereof. The training data may be raw vehicle data and/or processed vehicle data. Processed vehicle data may include raw vehicle data that has been manipulated or interpolated to provide additional information. Examples of processed data include mean data (e.g., averaged vehicle data from the duration of the vehicle maneuver), normalized data (e.g., normalized vehicle data from the duration of the vehicle maneuver), accumulated data, and differences in data over a select subsection of time (e.g., changes in vehicle data over a selected period of time during the vehicle maneuver). As will be appreciated, the training data may comprise both raw and processed vehicle data. For example, the training data may include raw speed data as well as mean speed data, normalized differences in speed data, differences in speed data over select subsections of time, etc.

[0123] As an example, if the previous vehicle maneuvers are acceleration maneuvers, the inventors of the present disclosure found that it may be useful for the training data to comprise vehicle data from the duration of the previous vehicle maneuvers such as a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, and a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time. Each of the selected subsections of time may independently be selected to correspond to, for example, an interval of time immediately after a vehicle maneuver is initiated such as a first 3 second interval of the vehicle maneuver. The vehicle data relating to speed, torque, acceleration, and energy were found to have a correlation (e.g., a positive or negative correlation) with weight-indicating labels such as predicted weights and/or predicted load states of the vehicles. The vehicle data relating to elevation and speed differences over a subsection of time were found to be useful in discriminating against outliers.

[0124] Of course, as will be appreciated, if the at least one machine learning model is to be trained using training data associated with previous vehicle maneuvers other than acceleration maneuvers, the training data may be different. That is, the types of vehicle data included in the training data may be different than that included for acceleration maneuvers.

[0125] For additional clarity, a method of training at least one machine learning model is shown in FIG. 9. As shown, the present disclosure also provides a method of training at least one machine learning model (900), the method comprising operating at least one processor to: receive vehicle data (910) associated with one or more vehicles, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of portions of vehicle data that are each associated with a vehicle maneuver and that each comprise a measured vehicle parameter profile; receive a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles (920) for at least one measured vehicle parameter profile; generate a plurality of error profiles (930) based on differences between each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles and the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles; determine, using the plurality of error profiles, an estimated vehicle weight (940) associated with each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles; and input the plurality of portions of vehicle data into the at least one machine learning

model (**950**) to thereby train the at least one machine learning model to estimate a weight of a vehicle using the vehicle data associated therewith.

[0126] In more detail, at **910** in FIG. **9**, vehicle data associated with one or more vehicles may be received. The vehicle data may be collected during operation of the one or more vehicles (e.g., using the sensor **138** of the telematics device **130**, or other techniques described herein). The vehicle data may comprise portions of vehicle data that are each associated with a vehicle maneuver (e.g., an acceleration maneuver) and that each comprise a measured vehicle parameter profile. As described herein, the measured vehicle parameter profile may generally be associated with the vehicle maneuver. For example, if the portion of vehicle data is associated with an acceleration maneuver, the measured vehicle parameter profile may be a measured speed profile, a measured torque profile, etc. As described herein, the vehicle data may be received by, for example, the telematics device **130** from the sensor **138**, the vehicle components **122**, or a combination thereof. Alternatively, or additionally, the fleet management system **110** may receive vehicle data from the telematics device **130**. Alternatively, or additionally, the processor **112** and/or the processor **132** may receive vehicle data from the data storage **114** and/or the data storage **134**.

[0127] As shown in FIG. **9** at **920**, a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be received. As described herein, the simulated vehicle parameter profiles generally correspond to the at least one of the measured vehicle parameter received profiles of the portions of vehicle data. That is, the simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be generated for the same type of vehicle maneuver that is associated with the at least one measured vehicle parameter. The plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be generated using a vehicle dynamics model, as described herein. As will be appreciated, the simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be pre-generated in that the simulated vehicle parameter profiles are generated prior to their use in the systems and methods of the present disclosure. Further, the plurality of simulated vehicle profiles may be received by any suitable device and/or system. For example, the fleet management system **110** (e.g., the processor **112**) and/or the telematics device **130** (e.g., processor **132**) may receive each of the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles (e.g., from the data storage **114** and/or data storage **134**).

[0128] At **930** in FIG. **9**, a plurality of error profiles based on differences between the at least one measured vehicle parameter profile and the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be generated. For example, the fleet management system **110** (e.g., processor **112**) and/or telematics device **130** (e.g., processor **132**) may generate the error profiles. As described herein, the error profiles may be generated based on differences between the measured vehicle parameter profile and the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles such as differences between the area under the curves of the simulated vehicle parameter profiles and the measured vehicle parameter profiles.

[0129] As shown in FIG. **9** at **940**, an estimated vehicle weight associated with each of the at least one measured vehicle parameter profiles may be determined using the plurality of error profiles. For example, the estimated weight of the vehicle may be determined by the fleet management system **110** (e.g., processor **112**) and/or telematics device **130** (e.g., processor **132**) may determine the estimated weight of the vehicle **120**. As described herein, the error profiles may be minimized and/or averaged to provide an estimated weight of the vehicle. For example, the estimated weight of the vehicle may be determined based on an average of candidate vehicle weights that minimize the error profiles, as described herein. As well, the candidate vehicle weights may be assigned difference weights based on the corresponding error profile. For example, the candidate vehicle weights may be weighted based on a sensitivity of the corresponding error profiles. The sensitivity of an error profile may correspond to the slope or rate of change of that error profile.

[0130] In some embodiments, the error profiles may determine whether a received portion of vehicle data is suitable for use to train the at least one machine learning model, as described herein. In more detail, the estimated weight of the vehicle may have error associated therewith that corresponds to the minimized and/or averaged error profiles. If the estimated weight of the vehicle

has an error associated therewith that is above a selected value, it may in some cases be desirable to omit from the training data the portion of vehicle data comprising the measured vehicle profile used to estimate the weight of the vehicle. As will be appreciated, a lower associated error value may indicate that a portion of vehicle data may result in a more accurate training of the at least one machine learning model. A maximum allowable associated error may be selected based on, for example, the amount of vehicle data available to train the at least one machine learning model, the types of measured vehicle parameter profiles received, etc. Examples of maximum allowable associated error may include 25%, 20%, 15%, 10%, 5%, etc.

[0131] At **950** in FIG. **9**, there is shown that the plurality of portions of vehicle data may be input into the at least one machine learning model to thereby train the at least one machine learning model to estimate a weight of a vehicle using the vehicle data associated therewith. That is, the portions of vehicle data may be used as training data for the at least one machine learning model. As described herein, the received portions of vehicle data may be used to direct the at least one machine learning model to associate specific portions of vehicle data (e.g., a measured vehicle parameter profile) related to particular types of vehicle maneuvers (e.g., acceleration maneuvers) with particular vehicle weights.

[0132] As also described herein, the training data may be labelled, partially labelled (i.e., a portion of the training data is labelled), or unlabelled. Thus, in some embodiments, the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be received for each measured vehicle parameter profile. In such embodiments, each measured vehicle parameter profile is therefore compared to a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles to generate the plurality of error profiles. An estimated vehicle weight may be determined and associated with each measured vehicle parameter profile and, as a result, the portions of vehicle data used to train the at least one machine learning model may be labelled with the estimated vehicle weight (e.g., a load state and/or a vehicle weight value).

[0133] However, in another embodiment, the training data may be unlabelled (e.g., for use with an unsupervised machine learning model). In such embodiments, the received vehicle data may be directly input into the at least one machine learning model without receiving the plurality of simulated vehicle profiles (**920**), generating the plurality of error profiles (**930**), and determining an estimated vehicle weight (**940**), as illustrated by the broken-line arrow in FIG. **9**. In such embodiments, it may be useful to select the types of vehicle data or measured vehicle parameter profiles included in each portion of vehicle data. As described herein, the inventors the present disclosure found that it may be useful to include vehicle data (or measure vehicle parameter profiles) collected from a duration of a vehicle maneuver such as, but not limited to, a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, and a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time. Thus, in some embodiments, the method of training at least one machine learning model (**900**) may comprise operating at least one processor to: receive vehicle data (**910**) associated with one or more vehicles, the vehicle data comprising a plurality of portions of vehicle data that are each associated with a vehicle maneuver and that each comprise a measured vehicle parameter profile comprising a normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, and a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof; and input the plurality of portions of vehicle data into the at least one machine learning model (**950**) to thereby train the at least one machine learning model to estimate a weight of a vehicle using the vehicle data associated therewith.

[0134] Of course, in some embodiments, the received vehicle data may be labelled. That is, in such embodiments, the received vehicle data is labelled vehicle data. The received labelled vehicle data may be directly input into the at least one machine learning model as described above in relation to

the use of unlabelled training data to train the at least one machine learning model and as illustrated by the broken-line arrow. In some embodiments, the received labelled vehicle data may be input into the at least one machine learning model with unlabelled vehicle data (e.g., for a semi-supervised machine learning model).

[0135] Once the at least one machine learning model is trained, the at least one machine learning model may be used to determine an estimated weight of the vehicle based on the portion of vehicle data associated with each of the one or more identified vehicle maneuvers. As will be appreciated, the portions of vehicle data associated with the identified one or more vehicle maneuvers will generally comprise the same types of vehicle data included in the training data, such as those described above. By using the portion of vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the trained at least one machine learning model may classify the vehicle performing the one or more vehicle maneuvers as a particular weight, as within a particular weight range, or based on the predicted load state of the vehicle (e.g., unloaded, loaded, or overloaded).

[0136] In some embodiments, the methods of the present disclosure may involve determining an estimation of the weight and a load state of the vehicle. An example of such an embodiment is shown in FIG. 10, wherein the method **1000** comprises receiving vehicle data (**1002**) associated with the vehicle, identifying one or more vehicle maneuvers (**1004**) each having associated therewith a portion of the vehicle data, receiving a plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles (**1006**) for a previous vehicle maneuver, generating a plurality of error profiles (**1008**) for each vehicle maneuver, determining an estimated weight of the vehicle (**1010**) by minimizing the plurality of error profiles, and using at least one machine learning model to determine a load state (**1012**) of the vehicle based on the portion of vehicle data associated with each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers.

[0137] The steps **1002**, **1004**, and **1012** of the method **1000** may generally be performed in the same manner as the steps **1002**, **1004**, and **1006**, respectively, of the method **300** described herein.

[0138] The steps **1006**, **1008**, and **1010** of the method **1000**, may be generally performed using techniques described above in relation to labelling training data for the at least one machine learning model. For example, the received plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be for one of the previous vehicle maneuvers used to train the at least one machine learning model. The previous vehicle maneuver from which the simulated vehicle parameter profiles are to be generated may be selected using any suitable technique. For example, some or all of the vehicle data associated with the previous vehicle maneuver may be compared to corresponding vehicle data associated with the one or more identified vehicle maneuvers to determine the similarity between the previous vehicle maneuver and the one or more identified vehicle maneuvers. In such cases, if the previous vehicle maneuver is determined to be similar to the one or more identified vehicle maneuvers, the simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be received therefor. The similarity between the previous vehicle maneuvers and the one or more identified vehicle maneuvers may be evaluated using any suitable technique. For example, a vehicle parameter profile associated with the previous vehicle maneuver may be compared to a vehicle parameter profile associated with the one or more identified vehicle maneuvers by determining a similarity score therebetween. The similarity score may be determined using, for example, various matching algorithms such as dynamic time warping algorithms.

[0139] The simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be selected based on the type of vehicle maneuver to be used for estimating the weight of the vehicle. For example, if acceleration maneuvers are to be used vehicle parameter profiles such as speed profiles and/or torque profiles may be selected. The plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be generated for the previous vehicle maneuver using a vehicle dynamics model, as described herein. As will be appreciated, the simulated vehicle parameter profiles may be pre-generated in that the simulated vehicle parameter profiles are generated prior to their use in the systems and methods of the present disclosure.

[0140] The plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles for each previous vehicle maneuver may be received using any suitable device and/or system. For example, the fleet management system **110** (e.g., the processor **112**) and/or the telematics device **130** (e.g., processor **132**) may receive each of the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles (e.g., from the data storage **114** and/or data storage **134**).

[0141] As shown in FIG. **10** at **1008**, a plurality of error profiles may be generated for each of the one or more vehicle maneuvers. For example, the fleet management system **110** (e.g., processor **112**) and/or telematics device **130** (e.g., processor **132**) may generate the error profiles. As described herein, the error profiles may be generated based on differences between the measured vehicle parameter profile and the plurality of simulated vehicle parameter profiles (e.g., differences between the area under the curves of the simulated vehicle parameter profiles and the measured vehicle parameter profiles).

[0142] In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **10** at **1010**, an estimation of the weight of the vehicle may be determined based on the plurality of error profiles. For example, the estimated weight of the vehicle may be determined by the fleet management system **110** (e.g., processor **112**) and/or telematics device **130** (e.g., processor **132**) may determine the estimated weight of the vehicle **120**. As described herein, the error profiles may be minimized and/or averaged to provide an estimated weight of the vehicle. For example, the estimated weight of the vehicle may be determined based on an average of candidate vehicle weights that minimize the error profiles, as described herein. As well, the candidate vehicle weights may be assigned difference weights based on the corresponding error profile. For example, the candidate vehicle weights may be weighted based on a sensitivity of the corresponding error profiles. The sensitivity of an error profile may correspond to the slope or rate of change of that error profile.

[0143] In some embodiments, the error profiles may determine whether the one or more identified vehicle maneuvers are suitable for use to determine the load state of the vehicle using the at least one machine learning model, as illustrated by the broken-line arrow in FIG. **10**. In more detail, the estimated weight of the vehicle will have error associated therewith that corresponds to the minimized and/or averaged error profiles. If the estimated weight of the vehicle has an error associated therewith that is above a selected value, it may in some cases be desirable to select a different one of the one or more vehicle maneuvers for use with the at least one machine learning model. As will be appreciated, a lower associated error value may indicate that the one or more vehicle maneuvers may result in a more accurate estimation provided by the at least one machine learning program. A maximum allowable associated error may be selected based on, for example, the number of identified vehicle maneuvers, the types of vehicle data associated with the one or more vehicle maneuvers, etc. Examples of maximum allowable associated error may include 25%, 20%, 15%, 10%, 5%, etc.

[0144] As will be appreciated, over the course of a trip, a vehicle may perform more than one vehicle maneuver. As a result, the weight of the vehicle may be estimated using the systems and/or methods of the present disclosure multiple times. In such situations, it may be desirable to use the plurality of estimated weights based on the plurality of vehicle maneuvers identified during the trip to provide an overall estimated vehicle weight. For example, the plurality of estimated weights may be averaged or aggregated (e.g., using a majority vote) to provide an overall estimated vehicle weight. As an example, if 15 vehicle maneuvers are identified during a trip, and 13 vehicle maneuverers indicate that the vehicle is “loaded” while 2 vehicle maneuvers indicate that the vehicle is “unloaded”, the vehicle may be estimated to be “loaded” based on the majority of estimations provided by the individual vehicle maneuvers. As will be appreciated, if weight values are estimated (i.e., rather than load state), the various estimated weights may be averaged to provide the overall estimated weight. Estimating the weight of the vehicle based on a plurality of vehicle maneuvers identified during a trip may be useful for discriminating against any outliers, if present.

[0145] Further, as described herein, at least one machine learning model may be used to determine the estimated weight of the vehicle. That is, in some embodiments, a plurality of machine learning models may be used to generate a plurality of vehicle weight estimations. In such embodiments, it may be desirable to use the plurality of vehicle weight estimations to provide a single final estimated vehicle weight. For example, the plurality of vehicle weight estimations may be averaged or aggregated, as described above in relation to the use of multiple vehicle maneuvers identified during a trip.

[0146] The example embodiments of the systems and methods described herein may be implemented as a combination of hardware or software. In some cases, the example embodiments described herein may be implemented, at least in part, by using one or more computer programs, executing on one or more programmable devices comprising at least one processing element, and a data storage element (including volatile memory, non-volatile memory, storage elements, or any combination thereof). Programmable hardware such as FPGA can also be used as standalone or in combination with other devices. These devices may also have at least one input device (e.g., a pushbutton keyboard, mouse, a touchscreen, and the like), and at least one output device (e.g., a display screen, a printer, a wireless radio, and the like) depending on the nature of the device. The devices may also have at least one communication device (e.g., a network interface).

[0147] It should also be noted that there may be some elements that are used to implement at least part of one of the embodiments described herein that may be implemented via software that is written in a high-level computer programming language such as object-oriented programming. Accordingly, the program code may be written in C, C++ or any other suitable programming language and may comprise modules or classes, as is known to those skilled in object-oriented programming. Alternatively, or in addition thereto, some of these elements implemented via software may be written in assembly language, machine language or firmware as needed. In either case, the language may be a compiled or interpreted language.

[0148] At least some of these software programs may be stored on a storage media (e.g., a computer readable medium such as, but not limited to, ROM, magnetic disk, optical disc) or a device that is readable by a general or special purpose programmable device. The software program code, when read by the programmable device, configures the programmable device to operate in a new, specific, and predefined manner in order to perform at least one of the methods described herein.

[0149] Furthermore, at least some of the programs associated with the systems and methods of the embodiments described herein may be capable of being distributed in a computer program product comprising a computer readable medium that bears computer usable instructions for one or more processors. The medium may be provided in various forms, including non-transitory forms such as, but not limited to, one or more diskettes, compact disks, tapes, chips, and magnetic and electronic storage.

[0150] Further, in the present disclosure, all terms referred to in singular form are meant to encompass plural forms of the same. Likewise, all terms referred to in plural form are meant to encompass singular forms of the same. Unless defined otherwise, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this disclosure pertains.

[0151] As used herein, the term “about” refers to an approximately $\pm 10\%$ variation from a given value. It is to be understood that such a variation is always included in any given value provided herein, whether or not it is specifically referred to.

[0152] It should be understood that the compositions and methods are described in terms of “comprising,” “containing,” or “including” various components or steps, the compositions and methods can also “consist essentially of” or “consist of” the various components and steps. Moreover, the indefinite articles “a” or “an,” as used in the claims, are defined herein to mean one or more than one of the element that it introduces.

[0153] For the sake of brevity, only certain ranges are explicitly disclosed herein. However, ranges from any lower limit may be combined with any upper limit to recite a range not explicitly recited, as well as, ranges from any lower limit may be combined with any other lower limit to recite a range not explicitly recited, in the same way, ranges from any upper limit may be combined with any other upper limit to recite a range not explicitly recited. Additionally, whenever a numerical range with a lower limit and an upper limit is disclosed, any number and any included range falling within the range are specifically disclosed. In particular, every range of values (of the form, “from about a to about b,” or, equivalently, “from approximately a to b,” or, equivalently, “from approximately a-b”) disclosed herein is to be understood to set forth every number and range encompassed within the broader range of values even if not explicitly recited. Thus, every point or individual value may serve as its own lower or upper limit combined with any other point or individual value or any other lower or upper limit, to recite a range not explicitly recited.

[0154] Therefore, the present disclosure is well adapted to attain the ends and advantages mentioned as well as those that are inherent therein. The particular embodiments disclosed above are illustrative only, as the present disclosure may be modified and practiced in different but equivalent manners apparent to those skilled in the art having the benefit of the teachings herein. Although individual embodiments are discussed, the disclosure covers all combinations of all those embodiments. Furthermore, no limitations are intended to the details of construction or design herein shown, other than as described in the claims below. Also, the terms in the claims have their plain, ordinary meaning unless otherwise explicitly and clearly defined by the patentee. It is therefore evident that the particular illustrative embodiments disclosed above may be altered or modified and all such variations are considered within the scope and spirit of the present disclosure. If there is any conflict in the usages of a word or term in this specification and one or more patent(s) or other documents that may be incorporated herein by reference, the definitions that are consistent with this specification should be adopted.

[0155] Many obvious variations of the embodiments set out herein will suggest themselves to those skilled in the art in light of the present disclosure. Such obvious variations are within the full intended scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A system for determining a load state of a vehicle, the system comprising: at least one data storage operable to store vehicle data associated with one or more vehicles; and at least one processor in communication with the at least one data storage, the at least one processor operable to: identify one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data, each vehicle maneuver being associated with a portion of the vehicle data; and determine the load state of the vehicle by inputting into at least one machine learning model each portion of vehicle data associated with the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the at least one machine learning model trained to determine a load state of a vehicle based on training data associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein each portion of vehicle data comprises geospatial data, vehicle engine data, or a combination thereof from a duration of the vehicle maneuver.
3. The system of claim 2, wherein each portion of vehicle data comprises normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the at least one machine learning model is trained to determine the load state of the vehicle based on training data that comprises an estimated vehicle weight value, a measured vehicle weight value, or a combination thereof associated with at least one of the plurality of vehicle maneuvers.

5. The system of claim 4, wherein an error associated with the estimated weight value is less than or equal to 25% based at least in part on the measured vehicle weight value.
 6. The system of claim 1, wherein the at least one machine learning model comprises a Random Forest model, an AutoEncoder, an AutoInt model, a Tabnet model, or a combination thereof.
 7. A method for determining the load state of a vehicle, the method comprising operating at least one processor to: receive vehicle data associated with one or more vehicles; identify one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data, each vehicle maneuver being associated with a portion of the vehicle data; and determine the load state of the vehicle by inputting into at least one machine learning model each portion of vehicle data associated with the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the at least one machine learning model trained to determine a load state of a vehicle based on training data associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.
 8. The method of claim 7, wherein each portion of vehicle data comprises geospatial data, vehicle engine data, or a combination thereof from a duration of the vehicle maneuver.
 9. The method of claim 8, wherein each portion of vehicle data comprises normalized accumulated RPM, a normalized accumulated torque, energy, a normalized difference in speed, a normalized difference in elevation, a mean acceleration, a normalized number of gear changes, a change in speed over a selected subsection of time, a change in elevation over a selected subsection of time, or a combination thereof.
 10. The method of claim 7, wherein the at least one machine learning model is trained to determine the load state of the vehicle based on training data that comprises an estimated vehicle weight value, a measured vehicle weight value, or a combination thereof associated with at least one of the plurality of vehicle maneuvers.
 11. The method of claim 10, wherein an error associated with the estimated weight value is less than or equal to 25% based at least in part on the measured vehicle weight value.
 12. The method of claim 7, wherein the at least one machine learning model comprises a Random Forest model, an AutoEncoder, an AutoInt model, a Tabnet model, or a combination thereof.
 13. A non-transitory computer readable medium having instructions stored thereon executable by at least one processor to implement a method for determining a load state of a vehicle, the method comprising operating the at least one processor to: receive vehicle data associated with one or more vehicles; identify one or more vehicle maneuvers based on the vehicle data, each vehicle maneuver being associated with a portion of the vehicle data; and determine the load state of the vehicle by inputting into at least one machine learning model each portion of vehicle data associated with the one or more vehicle maneuvers, the at least one machine learning model trained to determine a load state of a vehicle based on training data associated with a plurality of previous vehicle maneuvers.
-